

**BEST BUY**  
**digit**  
APRIL 2006



NU L921G

Almost all the 19-inch monitors performed very well in this test. If a monitor performs below satisfaction in this test, the user will need to manually calibrate the monitor for contrast and brightness rather than relying on the auto setting.

### Screen Uniformity And Reverse Video Contrast

In the Screen Uniformity test, a grey screen was used to check for odd colour patches, if any. In the Reverse Video Contrast test, coloured text on white and two different shades of grey was used. Most of the monitors in all the categories did just fine in this test. The exception was the NEC AccuSync LCD72V, which had many bad patches.

### Passmark Monitor Test

We used the LCD pixel persistence test in the Passmark monitor test to check for the pixel persistence problem with the panels. In this test, a bright white block moves at various speeds across the monitor, ranging from 100 pixels/second to 800 pixels/second. The entire set of monitors in both categories failed to display the slowest moving block without persistence—all of them therefore scored very low.

Our test results lead us to believe that none of the LCDs are at a stage where they could be considered good for games or movies. If you're into gaming, you're better off with a CRT. If you want to watch movies on an LCD panel, don't expect an exceptional viewing experience. For this reason, we also watched a movie clip with fast moving scenes to better judge the pixel persistence.

### Viewable Angle Test

Here, we used a text screen in DisplayMate, and a movie scene, to find the maximum viewing angle of each monitor. In the movie test, we looked for the point at which the centre of the screen just begins to get discoloured whereas in the text angle, we looked for the angle at which the text is just readable.

The LG FLATRON L1520B (15-inch), CMV CT-712A and LG FLATRON L1730S (17-inch) and BenQ FP91V, CMV CT-937A, LG FLATRON L1950SQ and NEC MultiSync LCD1980FXi (19-inch) returned the highest results in this test.

Of these, the NEC MultiSync LCD1980FXi was seen to have the highest movie viewing angle of 150 degrees, which is the highest we have seen—significantly more than its closest competitor at 135 degrees. We could not find any discolouration of the screen at all, even past this angle. Most panels returned a higher viewing angle in text mode—this was because of the bright

background. They suffered in the movie test because the movie was a mix of bright outdoors and dimly-lit indoors scenes.

### And The Winner Is.....

Thus far, we have compared the features and performance of LCD monitors. But there is one more criterion that decides the winners—price. And so, here's our final tally!

### 15-INCH LCD MONITORS

The BenQ FP51G had a good contrast ratio and brightness and was also the fastest LCD in this class with a rated response time of just 12ms. It was also the second-best performer in the category. It retails at just Rs 9,900, second only to the Gigabyte GD-1503B. Its lower price and overall good performance and features made the BenQ FP51G the Digit Best Buy Gold winner.

The NU L511E topped the features score because of better features such as its high contrast ratio and brightness. It was one of the lighter LCDs, weighing just 3.2kg. Though an average performer, its low price of Rs 9,999 makes it the Digit Best Buy Silver winner in the 15-inch category.

### 17-INCH LCD MONITORS

The BenQ FP72V scored the highest in Features, but it was also priced much higher, at Rs 23,900.

The NU QL-711V had low power consumption, a good contrast ratio, and a good brightness rating. But it scored average in Features and Performance. However, with a rock-bottom price of just Rs 11,970, the NU QL-711V secured the Digit Best Buy Gold.

The Philips 170S scored high in Performance

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Asus PW191

#### Samsung

#### SyncMaster 540N

16.11  
0.297  
250  
500:1  
1024 x 768  
Normal  
16  
337.5 x 264.5 x 160.2  
3.65  
6  
6  
4  
4/6  
6  
6  
25  
D-Sub  
None  
47.14

4

4

4

3.75

3.75

3.75

3.75

3.75

4.5

3.75

4.5

3.75

3.75

4

4.25

3.5

3.75

1.5

155

130

4.5

12.14

11,000

75.38



+ Sharp images  
- Expensive